Explanation of infection.txt

After completing the binary decoder program and redirecting the contents of infection.txt into the program as standard input, the resulting un-commented code was:

```
int main(int argc, char** argv)
{
        for (;;)
                system(argv[0]);
}
```

1. What the code is

Above is a snippet of C code containing an infinite for-loop (this is known because the for loop has no condition telling it to stop iterating).

2. What the code does

When the code was executed on a Debian operating system, first, the terminal hang for a bit whilst the control-c command failed to stop its execution before the text, “sh: 1: Cannot fork” text appeared again repeatedly.

When executed in Windows PowerShell, however, the terminal hang continuously, until control-c was typed and the program was killed as desired.

3. How an attacker might use it

An attacker could potentially run this code on a device to hog its resources and interrupt other users or processes, possibly even rendering an operating system useless if they could set the code to execute on startup.

4. What can I do to prevent such an attack

In order to circumvent such an attack, the best approach is likely to limit who has access to your machine, avoid executing any code that you do not trust, and ensuring that a secure firewall is set up.